

Your Essential Foot Care Guide

Professional tips for healthy, comfortable feet

Your feet work hard every day. This guide shares practical, professional advice to keep them healthy, comfortable, and functioning at their best. Whether you're on your feet all day, training regularly, or simply want to take better care of your feet, these tips will help.

1. Daily Foot Care Essentials

Establishing a simple daily routine prevents most common foot problems:

- Wash your feet daily with soap and warm water
- Dry thoroughly, especially between toes (moisture leads to fungal infections)
- Moisturise daily, avoiding between the toes
- Check for any changes, cuts, or areas of concern
- Trim toenails straight across (not curved) to prevent ingrown nails

2. Choosing the Right Footwear

Your shoes have a significant impact on foot health. Poor footwear is the leading cause of many foot problems:

- Ensure shoes fit properly with room for toes to move
- Replace worn-out shoes – cushioning degrades over time
- Avoid wearing the same pair every day (rotate between pairs)
- Choose breathable materials to reduce moisture
- If you're on your feet all day, invest in quality supportive footwear

3. Managing Hard Skin and Calluses

Hard skin develops as protection against pressure and friction. While some is normal, excessive build-up can become uncomfortable:

- Gently file hard skin after bathing when skin is soft
- Use a foot file or pumice stone – never cut or shave hard skin yourself

- Moisturise regularly to prevent dryness and cracking
- If hard skin returns quickly or causes pain, seek professional treatment
- Professional removal addresses the underlying cause, not just the symptom

4. Preventing and Treating Cracked Heels

Cracked heels are common but shouldn't be ignored. Deep cracks can become painful and infected:

- Apply a thick moisturiser or heel balm before bed
- Wear cotton socks overnight to lock in moisture
- Stay hydrated – dry skin often reflects overall hydration
- Avoid walking barefoot, especially on hard surfaces
- If cracks are deep, painful, or bleeding, seek professional help

5. Caring for Your Toenails

Healthy toenails require minimal but consistent care:

- Trim nails straight across, not too short
- File any sharp edges to prevent snagging
- Avoid cutting down the sides (this can lead to ingrown nails)
- Keep nails clean and dry
- If nails are thickened, discoloured, or painful, consult a professional

6. Supporting Active Feet

If you exercise regularly, run, or work on your feet, extra care is essential:

- Stretch your feet and calves before and after activity
- Replace athletic shoes every 300-500 miles or 6-12 months
- Consider compression socks for improved circulation and recovery
- Address discomfort early – don't push through foot pain
- Treatments like Thai foot massage aid recovery and prevent injury

7. When to Seek Professional Help

Some foot concerns require professional attention. Seek help if you experience:

- Persistent pain that doesn't improve with rest
- Thickened, discoloured, or damaged toenails
- Deep cracks or calluses that return quickly after removal
- Swelling, redness, or signs of infection
- Changes in skin colour or temperature
- Numbness or tingling

8. The Difference Between Beauty and Therapeutic Foot Care

Not all foot treatments are the same. Understanding the difference helps you choose the right care:

Beauty Pedicures: Focus on aesthetics – polish, appearance, relaxation. Suitable for general maintenance.

Therapeutic Foot Care: Addresses specific concerns like hard skin, cracked heels, damaged nails, or discomfort. Tailored treatments with professional techniques.

Podiatry: Medical foot care for conditions like diabetes-related foot problems, infections, or biomechanical issues.

Final Thoughts

Consistent, informed care makes a real difference to foot comfort and function. These simple practices, combined with professional treatment when needed, will keep your feet healthy and pain-free.

If you have ongoing concerns or need specialist foot care, The Sole Studio Norwich is here to help.

The Sole Studio Norwich

Suite G, Sapphire House, Roundtree Way, Norwich NR7 8SQ
hello@thesolestudionorwich.co.uk | 07854 918746